Unit 7 — Mediation: A Teen Magazine

Track E · Klasse 8 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can mediate a German teen-magazine article into 5–6 English sentences for a peer.*
- *I can keep dates, advice, and key facts; drop ceremony and decorative phrasing.*
- *I can use 5 reporting verbs (says, explains, advises, warns, recommends).*

Lead-in I

Jonas's German cousin sent him a teen-magazine article about phone use at night. Jonas's English-speaking pen-pal had asked: *what do German teen mags say about this?* Jonas read the article twice. Then he closed it and wrote five English sentences from memory.

Vocabulary I

- to say
- to explain
- to advise (someone to)
- to recommend
- to warn (someone about)
- to mention
- to claim
- to point out

Reading I

Source — *German teen-mag article (excerpt)*
Studien zeigen, dass Jugendliche, die ihr Handy nachts neben dem Bett liegen haben, im Schnitt 30 Minuten weniger schlafen als ihre Mitschüler. Experten empfehlen, das Gerät außerhalb des Schlafzimmers zu laden. Eltern sollten dabei mit gutem Beispiel vorangehen.

Mediation — three rules

1. *Who is reading?* — adjust greeting and tone.
2. *What do they need to know?* — keep facts, drop decoration.

Reading II

3. *What is the smallest version that gets them there?*

Reporting verbs
to say, to explain, to advise (someone to), to recommend, to warn (someone about), to mention, to claim, to point out.

- *Studies show that …*
- *Experts recommend that …*
- *Parents are advised to …*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Match German verb to English: *empfehlen — ?, warnen — ?, erklären — ?, behaupten — ?*.
2. Choose: *say / explain / recommend* — Studies _____ that teens lose sleep. Experts _____ that the phone be charged outside the bedroom.

Niveau E — productive

3. Build a 4-sentence English mediation of the source article above for an English-speaking friend.

Your turn I

mediation (”Mediation”), 6 sentences. Read the German source above. Write 6 English sentences for an English-speaking friend who has asked what the article says. Use 3 reporting verbs.

Sample

Hi Jordan, here’s the gist of that German article. It says that teenagers who keep their phones next to the bed sleep about 30 minutes less on average than those who don’t. Experts recommend charging the phone outside the bedroom. Parents are advised to set the example. The article also points out that this is not about willpower — it’s about how the brain reacts to screens at night.

Reflect I

- I can mediate a German article into 6 English sentences.
- I can keep facts and drop decoration.
- I can use 3 reporting verbs.

Further reading / listening I

- Goethe-Institut — Beispiel-Aufgaben language mediation (Sprachmittlung) Englisch (Sek I).
- Landesbildungsserver BW — mediation (”Mediation”)-Beispielaufgaben.